



## Act II

### Scene I

*Another part of the island.*

*(Enter ALONSO, SEBASTIAN, ANTONIO, GONZALO, ADRIAN, FRANCISCO, and others)*

GONZALO

*(To ALONSO)*

eseech you, sir, be merry; you have cause,  
So have we all, of joy; for our escape

Is much beyond our loss. Our hint of woe

Is common; every day some sailor's wife,

The masters of some merchant and the merchant

Have just our theme of woe; but for the miracle,

I mean our preservation, few in millions

Can speak like us: then wisely, good sir, weigh

Our sorrow with our comfort.

ALONSO

Prithce, peace.

SEBASTIAN

*[Aside to ANTONIO] He receives comfort like cold porridge.*

ANTONIO

The visitor will not give him o'er so.

SEBASTIAN

Look he's winding up the watch of his wit; by and by it will strike.

GONZALO

*(To ALONSO)* Sir,—

SEBASTIAN

One: tell.

GONZALO

When every grief is entertain'd that's offer'd,  
Comes to the entertainer—

SEBASTIAN

A dollar.

GONZALO

Dolour comes to him, indeed: you have spoken truer than you  
purposed.

SEBASTIAN

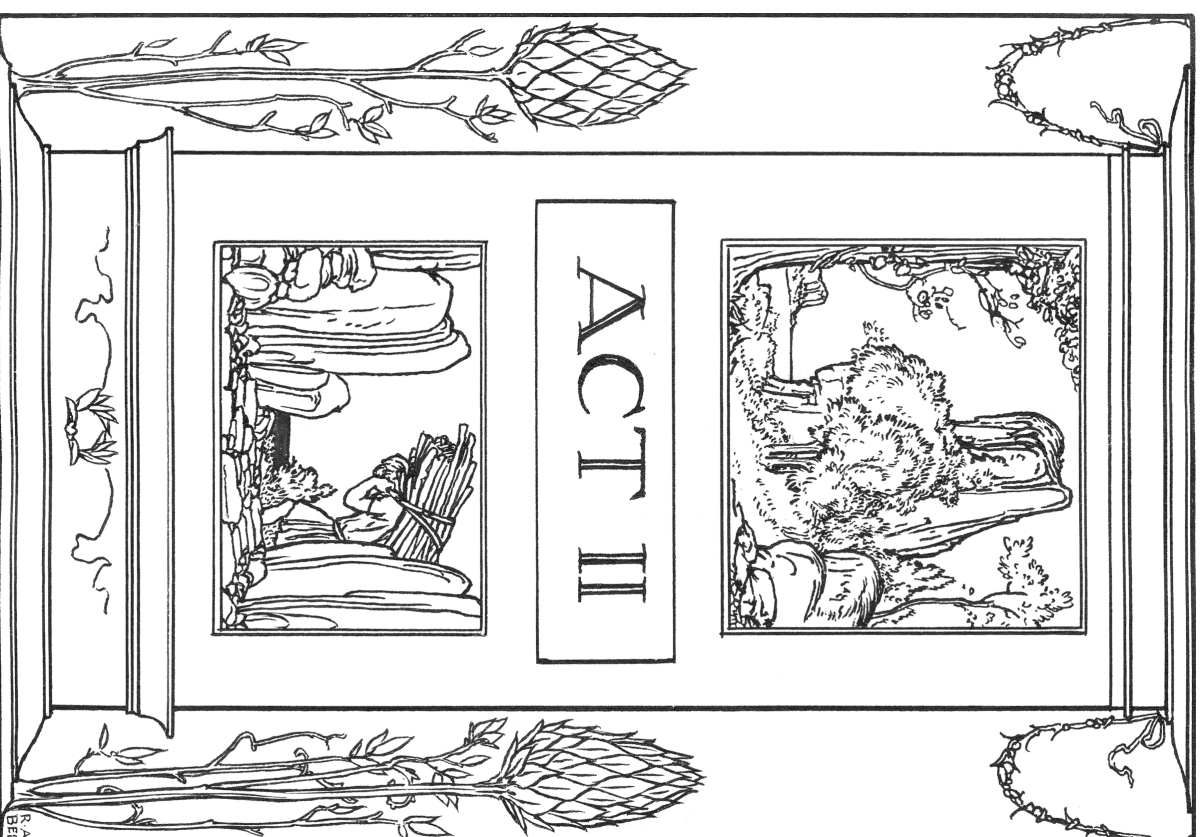
You have taken it wiselier than I meant you should.

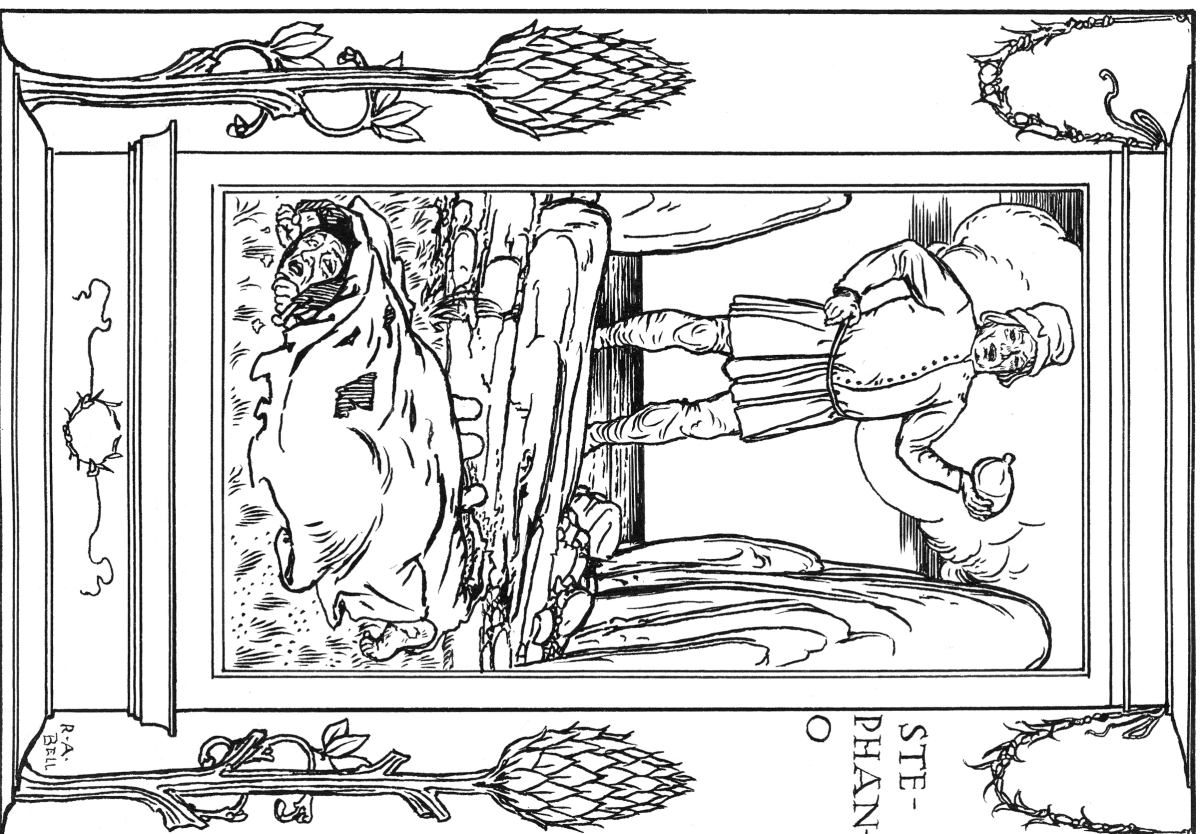
GONZALO

*(To ALONSO)* Therefore, my lord,—

ANTONIO

Fie, what a spendthrift is he of his tongue!





ALONSO

*(To GONZALO)* I prithee, spare.

GONZALO

Well, I have done: but yet,—

SEBASTIAN

*[Aside to ANTONIO]* He will be talking.

ANTONIO

*[Aside to SEBASTIAN]* Which, of be or Adrian, for a good wager, first begins to crow?

SEBASTIAN

The old cock.

ANTONIO

The cockerel.

SEBASTIAN

Done. The wager?

ANTONIO

A laughter.

SEBASTIAN

A match!

ADRIAN

Though this island seem to be desert,—

SEBASTIAN

Ha, ha, ha! So, you're paid.

ADRIAN

Uninhabitable and almost inaccessible,—

SEBASTIAN

Yet,—

ADRIAN  
Yet,—

ANTONIO  
He could not miss't.

ADRIAN  
It must needs be of subtle, tender and delicate temperance.

ANTONIO  
Temperance was a delicate wench.

SEBASTIAN  
Ay, and a subtle; as he most learnedly delivered.

ADRIAN  
The air breathes upon us here most sweetly.

SEBASTIAN  
As if it had lungs and rotten ones.

ANTONIO  
Or as 'twere perfumed by a fen.

GONZALO  
Here is everything advantageous to life.

ANTONIO  
True; save means to live.

SEBASTIAN  
Of that there's none, or little.

GONZALO  
How lush and lusty the grass looks! how green!

ANTONIO  
The ground indeed is tawny.

SEBASTIAN  
With an eye of green in't.

(*To FERDINAND*)  
Follow me.

(*To ARIEL*)  
Hark what thou else shalt do me.

MIRANDA

Be of comfort;  
My father's of a better nature, sir,  
Than he appears by speech: this is unwonted  
Which now came from him.

PROSPERO

Thou shalt be free  
As mountain winds: but then exactly do  
All points of my command.

ARIEL

To the syllable.

PROSPERO  
Come, follow. Speak not for him.  
(*Exeunt*)





PROSPERO

Silence! one word more  
Shall make me chide thee, if not hate thee. What!  
An advocate for an imposter! hush!  
Thou think'st there is no more such shapes as he,  
Having seen but him and Caliban: foolish wench!  
To the most of men this is a Caliban  
And they to him are angels.

MIRANDA

My affections  
Are then most humble; I have no ambition  
To see a goodlier man.

PROSPERO

(*To FERDINAND*)

Come on; obey:  
Thy nerves are in their infancy again  
And have no vigour in them.

FERDINAND

So they are;  
My spirits, as in a dream, are all bound up.  
My father's loss, the weakness which I feel,  
The wreck of all my friends, nor this man's threats,  
To whom I am subdued, are but light to me,  
Might I but through my prison once a day  
Behold this maid: all corners else o' the earth  
Let liberty make use of; space enough  
Have I in such a prison.

PROSPERO

[*Aside*] *It works.*

(*To FERDINAND*)

Come on.  
Thou hast done well, fine Ariel!

ANTONIO

He misses not much.

SEBASTIAN

No; he doth but mistake the truth totally.

GONZALO

But the rarity of it is,—which is indeed almost  
beyond credit,—

SEBASTIAN

As many vouched rarities are.

GONZALO

That our garments, being, as they were, drenched in the sea, hold  
notwithstanding their freshness and glosses, being rather new-dyed than  
stained with salt water.

ANTONIO

If but one of his pockets could speak, would it not say he lies?

SEBASTIAN

Ay, or very falsely pocket up his report

GONZALO

Methinks our garments are now as fresh as when we put them on first in  
Afric, at the marriage of the king's fair daughter Claribel to the King of  
Tunis.

SEBASTIAN

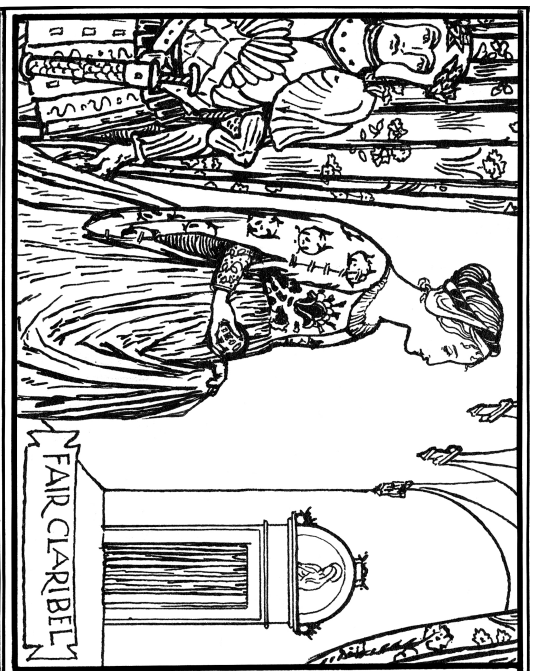
'Twas a sweet marriage, and we prosper well in our return.

ADRIAN

Tunis was never graced before with such a paragon to  
their queen.

GONZALO

Not since widow Dido's time.



ANTONIO

Widow! a pox o' that! How came that widow in? widow Dido!

SEBASTIAN

What if he had said 'widower Æneas' too? Good Lord, how you take it!

ADRIAN

(*To GONZALO*) 'Widow Dido' said you? you make me study of that: she was of Carthage, not of Tunis.

GONZALO

This Tunis, sir, was Carthage.

ADRIAN

Carthage?

GONZALO

I assure you, Carthage.

SEBASTIAN

His word is more than the miraculous harp; he hath



PROSPERO

What? I say,

My foot my tutor? Put thy sword up, traitor;  
Who makest a show but darrest not strike, thy conscience  
Is so possess'd with guilt: come from thy ward,  
For I can here disarm thee with this stick  
And make thy weapon drop.

MIRANDA

Beseech you, father.

PROSPERO

Hence! hang not on my garments.

MIRANDA

Sir, have pity;

I'll be his surety.

(*To FERDINAND*)

One word more; I charge thee  
That thou attend me: thou dost here usurp  
The name thou owest not; and hast put thyself  
Upon this island as a spy, to win it  
From me, the lord on't.

FERDINAND

No, as I am a man.

MIRANDA

There's nothing ill can dwell in such a temple:  
If the ill spirit have so fair a house,  
Good things will strive to dwell with't.

PROSPERO

(*To FERDINAND*)

Follow me.

(*To MIRANDA*)

Speak not you for him; he's a traitor.

(*To FERDINAND*)

Come;

I'll manacle thy neck and feet together:  
Sea-water shalt thou drink; thy food shall be  
The fresh-brook muscles, wither'd roots and husks  
Wherein the acorn cradled. Follow.

FERDINAND

No;

I will resist such entertainment till  
Mine enemy has more power.

(*He draws, and is charmed from moving*)

MIRANDA

O dear father,

Make not too rash a trial of him, for  
He's gentle and not fearful.



raised the wall and houses too.

ANTONIO

What impossible matter will he make easy next?

SEBASTIAN

I think he will carry this island home in his pocket  
and give it his son for an apple.

ANTONIO

And, sowing the kernels of it in the sea, bring  
forth more islands.

GONZALO

Ay.

ANTONIO

Why, in good time.

GONZALO

(*To ALONSO*) Sir, we were talking that our garments seem now

as fresh as when we were at Tunis at the marriage of your daughter, who is now queen.

ANTONIO

And the rarest that e'er came there.

SEBASTIAN

Bate, I beseech you, widow Dido.

ANTONIO

O, widow Dido! ay, widow Dido.

GONZALO

(*To ALONSO*) Is not, sir, my doublet as fresh as the first day I wore it? I mean, in a sort.

ANTONIO

That sort was well fished for.

GONZALO

(*To ALONSO*) When I wore it at your daughter's marriage?

ALONSO

You cram these words into mine ears against  
The stomach of my sense. Would I had never  
Married my daughter there! for, coming thence,  
My son is lost and, in my rate, she too,  
Who is so far from Italy removed  
I ne'er again shall see her. O thou mine heir  
Of Naples and of Milan, what strange fish  
Hath made his meal on thee?

FRANCISCO

Sir, he may live:  
I saw him beat the surges under him,  
And ride upon their backs; he trod the water,  
Whose enmity he flung aside, and breasted  
The surge most swoln that met him; his bold head  
Bove the contentious waves he kept, and oar'd



(*To FERDINAND*)

A word, good sir;  
I fear you have done yourself some wrong: a word.

MIRANDA

Why speaks my father so ungently? This  
Is the third man that e'er I saw, the first  
That e'er I sigh'd for: pity move my father  
To be inclined my way!

FERDINAND

O, if a virgin,  
And your affection not gone forth, I'll make you  
The queen of Naples.

PROSPERO

Soft, sir! one word more.  
[*Aside*] They are both in either's powers; but this swift business  
I must uneasy make, lest too light winning  
Make the prize light.